

CHRISTOPHER FITZSIMMONS DIES IN COLUMBIA

Pioneer in Cotton Seed Oil Industry and Leading Citizen of Capital City

Columbia, Oct. 8.—Christopher FitzSimmons, widely known citizen of Columbia and for years a recognized authority in the cottonseed oil industry, died at his residence, 1117 Barnwell street, yesterday afternoon at 5 o'clock after an illness extending over a week.

The funeral services will be held this afternoon at 4:30 o'clock at Trinity Episcopal church. The funeral party will leave Columbia for Charleston Friday morning at 6 o'clock and interment will be in the family lot at Magnolia cemetery, Charleston.

Mr. FitzSimmons was born in Charleston January 26, 1856, and was a son of Dr. Christopher FitzSimmons and Susan Milliken (Barker) FitzSimmons. He received his education at the Carolina Military Institute, Charlotte, N. C., under the veteran educator, Col. John P. Thomas. He started out in life as a civil engineer but it was not long before he became interested in the cottonseed oil industry. He was truly a pioneer in this business. Commencing as a salesman in 1880, he rose, step by step, to the highest position in his chosen occupation.

It is said of Mr. FitzSimmons that he was the first salesman to buy a whole carload of cotton seed. He traveled about over the state in the early years of the industry trying to induce cotton planters to dispose of their cotton seed.

At that time, cotton seed was largely a waste product, though to some extent it was used for feed and fertilizer. His advancement in the cotton seed business was rapid and he was largely instrumental in the purchase of a number of large oil mills which led to the formation of the Southern Cotton Oil company. He was offered the vice presidency of this company, preferring to remain in his native state, he was made general manager of the company.

Mr. FitzSimmons was a recognized authority upon all questions in the cottonseed oil industry and it was generally conceded that he was the best informed man in his profession in the entire southern states. Not only was his ability in his chosen field of work recognized, but there was no man ever connected with a large and influential corporation that was more beloved than was Mr. FitzSimmons.

Ever ready to recognize talent and worth in his subordinates, no man did more than he to advance the fortunes of those associated in business with him. He was actively interested in bringing about the organization of the Interstate Cotton Seed Crushers' association and served as its president in 1904-1905. He also gave effective aid in the organization of the South Carolina Cotton Seed Crushers' association, serving as president in 1907-1908.